

In the genes

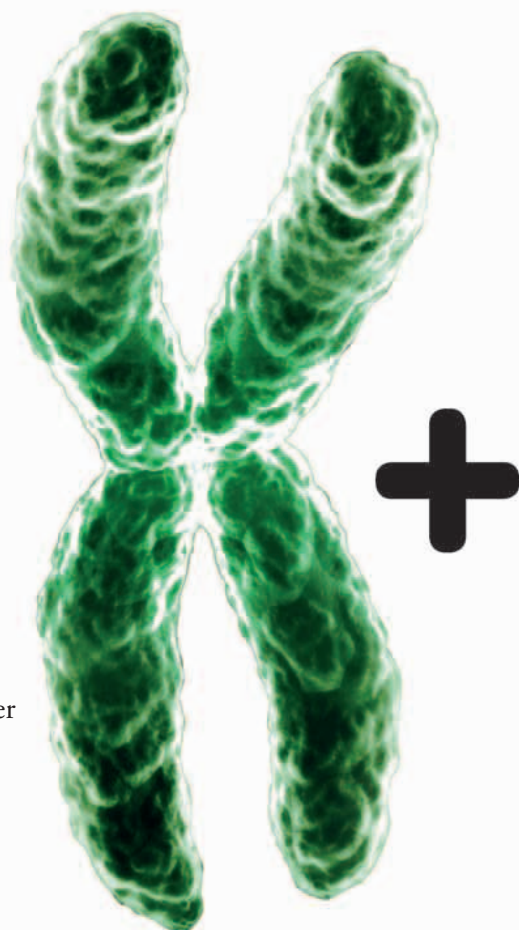
We inherit 23 gene-carrying chromosomes from each of our parents. When a sperm fertilizes an egg, a full set of 46 chromosomes—containing thousands of genes—begins building a new human body. Our genes help make each of us a unique individual.

WOW!

A human body cell contains around 23,000 genes, which is not many more than those found in a mouse!

GIRL OR BOY

Two of the 46 chromosomes are special. Called the X and Y chromosomes, they control whether an embryo develops into a boy or a girl. If the embryo receives an X chromosome from the mother and a Y chromosome from the father, it will become a boy. If it receives an X chromosome from both parents, it will become a girl.

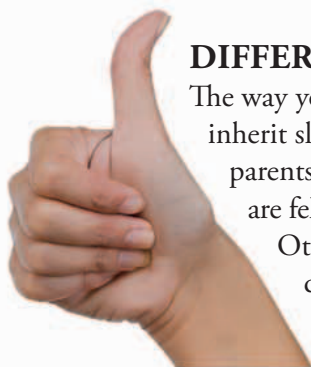


X chromosome

DIFFERENT FEATURES

The way you look depends on your genes. You may inherit slightly different versions of genes from your parents. Some genes are dominant and their effects are felt regardless of the other version you inherited.

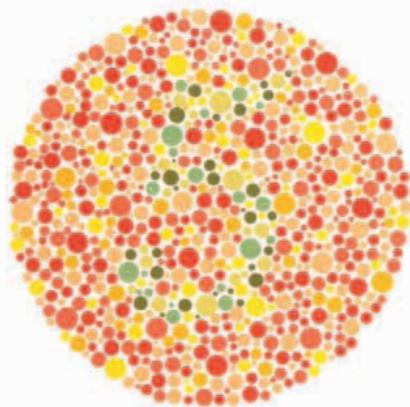
Others are recessive and only take effect if no dominant gene is present. If you can bend your thumb back like this, you have two recessive thumb-bending genes.



COLOR BLINDNESS

If you can't see the number 5 in this circle, you have red-green color blindness. A color-blind person cannot tell the difference between two colors.

This problem is caused by a gene inherited from the mother, but it mainly affects males.



Color-blindness test

